SOP Inbox On call Data Scientist 2024-08-05

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Version Control

Version	1.0
Author	1.0 `@Ruth I. Baker` 1.1 `@Maddy Ovenden`
Date of update	`1 Aug 2025`
Content of update	• Combined the ad hoc guide and the detail on this role from the inbox sop • Changed to reflect new extra duties re hpdw/dashboard access • 1.1 Added the instructions for the new short ad hoc requests process and updated the email address references to the new Regions.DataScience@ukhsa.gov.uk mailbox address.
Document Status	`LIVE`

Audience / Purpose

This SOP is specifically for the data scientist on call. It includes the finer details of how and when to generate Jira tickets for specific types of email content and how to respond. It also includes top tips for some of the types of requests or issues that require coding or working in HPDW.

Please use this search bar to look up what to do with specific types of emails:

Search

1.Set Up

1.1 Accesses

Shared drive

Share point

github

inbox

(sending from inbox)

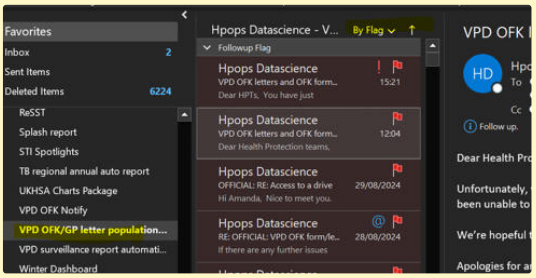
see all folders in inbox

team signature

power bi flow

- If you're having problems with the shared mailbox e.g. you don't have the dropdown menu to select Regions.DataScience@ukhsa.gov.uk, try and reconnect the mailbox.
  - go to Control Panel - Mail (Microsoft Outlook) (32-bit) - Email accounts
  - Delete Regions.DataScience@ukhsa.gov.uk
  - Click 'New'
  - Re-add Regions.DataScience@ukhsa.gov.uk. A sign in box will appear, sign in with your **personal account** (e.g. john.smith@ukhsa.gov.uk)

TOP TIP: Inside each folder in the inbox, if you set it to order by 'flag', you will find a series of useful emails regarding things like comms that we send regularly that you can use as a template email for certain scenarios.



1.2 Rota & responsibilities

The rota can be found on Shifts.

1.3 Inbox Process / Flagged emails

1. Check the inbox 3 times a day 10:00, 14:00, 16:00 (the inbox manager will contact you directly for any urgent/time sensitive queries that require an immediate response)
2. Look for emails flagged with 'data scientist' - dark blue colour
3. Review this SOP on how to action the email - if you do not think the email fits into any of the categories captured here, contact the inbox manager directly.
4. Generate a Jira ticket if required (adding the email to the ticket) and if the ad hoc request is not related to an existing epic, it needs to be linked to the ongoing epic for short ad hoc requests [FSDS-3610] Short ad hoc requests (less 0.5 FTE days work) - Jira. However if the ad hoc request is likely to generate over 0.5 FTE days worth of work, this warrants logging to an individual new epic.
5. respond to the stakeholder if required from the Regions.DataScience@ukhsa.gov.uk email. [Copy in Regions.DataScience@ukhsa.gov.uk if you have asked questions that require a response and mark the new email with 'awaiting response' colour - THIS INCLUDES YOUR OWN if you've sent a place holder response).

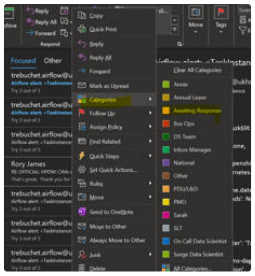
-any communication with stakeholders or end users should have a **Jira ticket number in the subject title**

-if the person handling the ticket/communication is **not** the on call or surge data scientist, **they should be copied in**to the email chain to reply directly themselves

In this scenario for a new ticket, use the below template

"Thank you for contacting us with this query. We have passed this query to our colleague XXXXXX who will investigate for you. XXXX, this query is registered under FSDS-XXXXXX. Kind regards.....

you do this by right clicking the relevant email and selecting categorize > awaiting response



6. Go to your sent box and include your email response to the Jira ticket as a comment

> ⚠ Please add all emails into the comments section of the Jira ticket, if there is a Jira ticket. Please capture the below part of the email by pressing 'reply' or 'forward' and then copying the email. **(Do not copy emails in the chain which are already in the Jira ticket!)**
>
> **From:** firstname surname <Yfirstname.surname@ukhsa.gov.uk>
> **Sent:** 20 November 2023 17:16
> **To:** Firstname Surname Florence <firstname.surname@ukhsa.gov.uk>;
> **Subject:** RE: OFFICIAL: TO NOTE: Business Plan Updates - November 2023

7. Mark the original email 'as complete' by ticking the red flag
8. Carry out the required work updating your Jira ticket as necessary
9. Email the stakeholder (and everyone copied in) with updates/when the work is completed and include the email chain in the Jira ticket comment
10. Mark the Jira ticket as done and log your time

1.4 Creating Jira tickets

If you need a refresher on Jira ticketing please see here: How to generate a Jira Ticket and move this through the workflow and here How to add the relevant Jira component - Regions Data Science - Confluence (phe.org.uk). The current list of components is available here: Regions Data Science - Jira (phe.org.uk)

As a general rule check the following:

1. If you need to add a ticket (sometimes a ticket exists already but the email with the surge flag has no ticket number in it)
2. You've added it to the relevant epic (under 0.5 days work needs to be added to either existing epic or the short ad hoc requests epic [FSDS-3610] Short ad hoc requests (less 0.5 FTE days work) - Jira, over 0.5 days warrants logging as a new independent epic)
3. You've added a due date - generally within 3 days if its a service issue
4. You've added the relevant component (will be mentioned in the action)
5. You've assigned the issue
6. You've moved the issue to do and its not invisible in the backlog
7. You've logged your time on the issue if you're assigning it to someone else but ended up in communication before the issue was logged
8. You've added the original email chain to the issue and your response in the comments

2. New maintenance/Bug/User issues or queries relating to Front End Products

If a project relates to a back end product that should be assigned to the surge data scientist. Please re-assign the flag to them. The only exceptions here are the VPD OFK Notify and the letter automation process - where feature requests should be dealt with by the on call data scientist but issues with the pipeline running should be dealt with by the surge data scientist.

2.1 Overview (front end products in development)

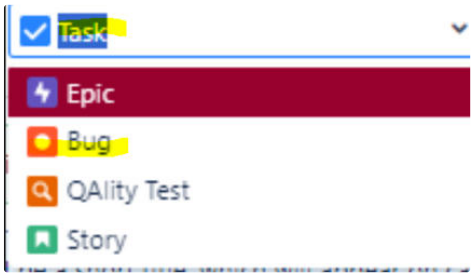
> ⚠ If it is an ongoing issue which is currently being managed by someone else in the team, the adding of these emails into the relevant Jira issue should be managed by the Surge data scientist. Change the flag colour and remove the on call data scientist flag for them to action it instead.

Project Status	Recipients	Subject Matter	Action
In development/tech spec etc	includes current project lead. HPOps not specifically addressed	NA	Add to the relevant project epic as a comment - mark complete
In development/ tech spec etc	includes current project lead. HPOps specifically addressed	NA	Check with Project lead. If project led will action then NA and just move straight into relevant project folder.
In development/ tech spec etc	Does not include current project lead	1. general update 2. Query	Reply all - include the Project lead for below reason: 1. forwarding for awareness to project lead and add as a comment to the epic for the current project version 2. reply all and include the project lead - 'I'm passing this to the project lead to respond to your query'
In Production/Already live (no current version in development)	NA	1. Product Feedback 2. Product query	**See section 2.2**

2.2 Product Feedback, Product Query or Bug query relating to a live front end product (Not currently in dev)

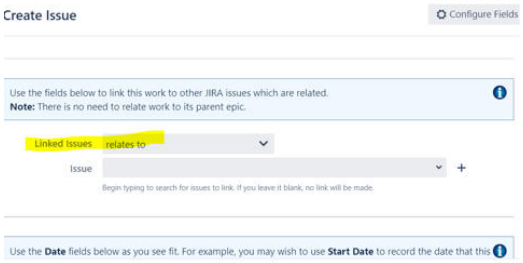
1) Add the feedback/issue on jira. **These are epic-less issues!**

2) Decide if the issue type is 1) a task (general product feedback/user issue) or 2) a bug.



3) Add the component called [End Users: Product feedback]

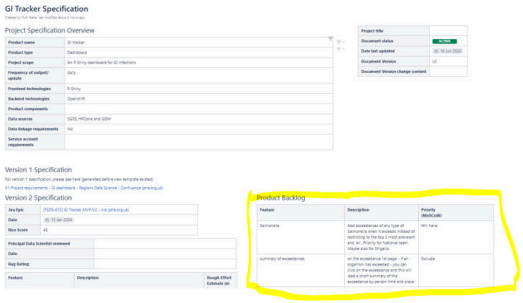
4) in the "Linked issues" Section, select "relates to" and add the issue ticket number for the latest epic that was developed (*do not put this in the 'epic link' field - this task is not part of the epic because the epic should already be closed now that the product released is in its latest version and we do not wish it to return to the kanban board*).



Top Tip

You can find all of our epics if you look in the epic link field and there you can find the relevant epic issue number

5. Respond to the stakeholder and then carry out the actions. (Under the new process decided by Team lead since `18 Jan 2024` the on call data scientist, with support from the last project lead on the product, are now responsible for resolving any maintenance issues with an existing product (if there is no former project lead then please contact someone who has previously worked on the project)

Original Email Query Content	Email response (include Jira ticket in subject title)	Action
General feedback on the product (task issue)	Dear XXXXX, Thank you for taking the time to provide the below feedback. I will ensure we have captured this information to be reviewed when scoping begins for the next version of this product. Kind regards	Confirm with latest project lead if any of the information/ideas are new to them: - if yes, complete the Jira ticket by adding the ideas to the product backlog of the technical specification page of the relevant product -if no, note time spent on investigating and then can complete the ticket with an explanation that feedback already captured in tech spec for next version 

Specific user training/correct software issue (task issue) or issue with the product (bug issue)	Dear XXXX,
	
	Thank you for raising this with our team. I will investigate this matter and provide an update by DD/MM/YYYY.
	
	Kind regards
		Send holding email and then select one of the actions from row below Investigate if it is an issue 1) with the product 2) a skills problem for the user, or 3) data fields not being up to date.
		
		If 1), investigate how to resolve - please go to the former project lead for support and inform them of the issue you will be investigating out of courtesy.
		
		If 2) change the component [End Users: Skills_training_support]() instead and provide support on the task. If you spend longer than 30 minutes providing support or you think it will take longer, review with surge if this is appropriate or if it should be escalated to team leads.
		
		A possible solution here:
		
		• Problems with using/installing internally hosted packages on Super VM's (virtual machines)
		  ◦ Advice to submit a service request of what needs to be installed (usually the right R version for the internally hosted R package from GitLab, catalogue 'Infrastructure and Hosting'.
		  ◦ Advice to try running `curl https://gitlab.phe.gov.uk/` in their git bash terminal on that virtual machine
		  ◦ May have to submitted a SNOW request for the user. ICT need to get the UKHSA certificate chain properly enabled on VMs, not just in the browsers, so that client tools like git and R can do SSL connections to services on the WAN, not just the public internet.

If 3) and it is not due to an issue with the product, investigate if the view/table/database is up-to-date.

Troubling shooting existing products - Issue with data fields

If you receive a maintenance issue with an existing live product that data seems out of date/not updated, first check that there is not a problem with the product causing this. If not, and/or you've had confirmation that data has not been refreshed by the central team, take the following steps

- DO NOT rely on the central team to send out correspondence if an update has failed such as SGSS, this has not always been reliable.
- Ask the G7 on duty if they have heard anything, and/or email the central team responsible for the example database that you suspect is not updated.
- Once you have received confirmation from the central team, you will need to inform stakeholders/users of affected products. Use the product releases page and check if the database in question is being used for which product.
- Identify who will be affected. All Field Service and HPT central inboxes will need to be contacted, contact information is found here. Also contact any members of staff who have non-Regions PII access. The links to this information is found here.
- CC in Obaghe to the email and also prompt either Alex or Isaac to provide an update for context.
- Once every affected has been identified, please check with surge and the inbox manager before sending, here is an example email to send:

  'Dear All,

  The Regions Data Science team have become aware that SGSS is currently experiencing an issue with its data transfer from the operational database to the SGSS data warehouse.

  This means that there has been no refresh of SGSS data into HPDW and Regions Data Science products (GI Tracker, Winter dashboard, GAS dashboard) since Tuesday 23rd April; SGSS data shown in these products is from that date. This is outside of our team's control, so we cannot provide a timescale for resolution, but we will update you when our systems are back to normal.

  Please pass this information on to database and dashboard users in your teams.

  Apologies for any inconvenience caused,

  Regions Data Science team'

3. Access to RDS products

3.1 Overview

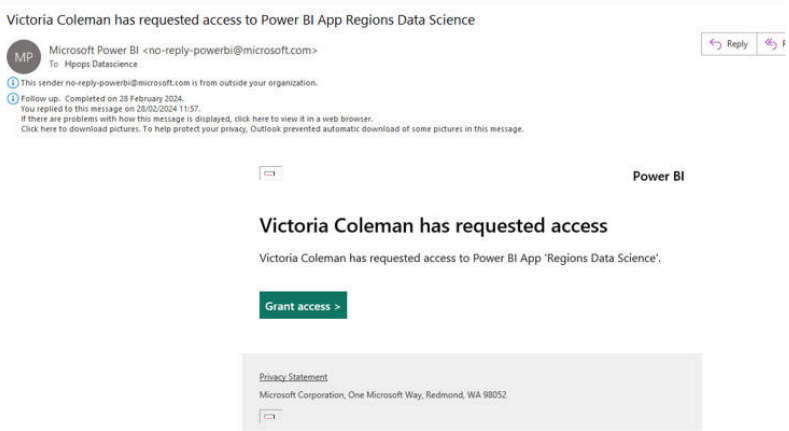
There are several types of product access requests that come into the inbox. The information on the entire access process depending on if the requester is from the Regions Directorate or another area of the organisation can all be found here - please familiarise yourself - [RDS Dashboard Access Process - Regions Data Science - Confluence (phe.org.uk)](#).

⚠ NB These requests are separate from access issues that relate to HPDW (which can be found inside section 4 of this SOP)

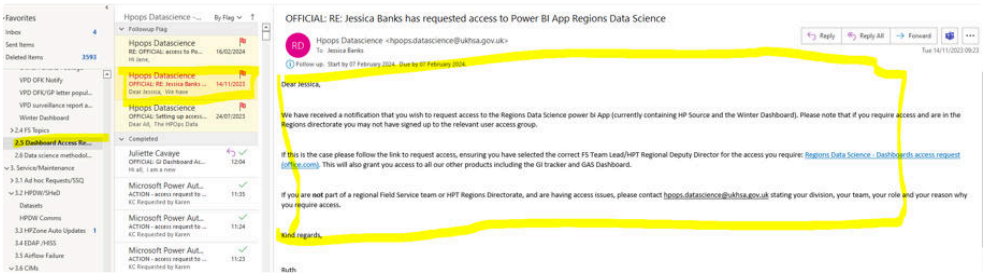
The majority of access issues/request do not get a Jira ticket apart from option 4 below

1. Power bi automatic Dashboard requests (automatic requests that arise from people trying to access either 1) HP Source or 2) the Winter Dashboard which sit inside the Regions Data Science Dashboard.
2. Specific power bi dashboard request from someone who still cannot access HP Source/Winter Dashboard
3. Power automate requests (automatic requests that arrive in your personal inbox when an endorser (FS regional team lead or HPT Regional Deputy Director) has approved a staff member being added into their teams MS Azure group)
4. Specific email requests from either an individual or from one of our own team asking that a non regions directorate staff be granted access to a specific product
5. specific email from a regions directorate staff who still does not have access even though they've completed the MS form

3.2 Dashboard/Product Access Issues - Power Bi Auto email (no Jira ticket)



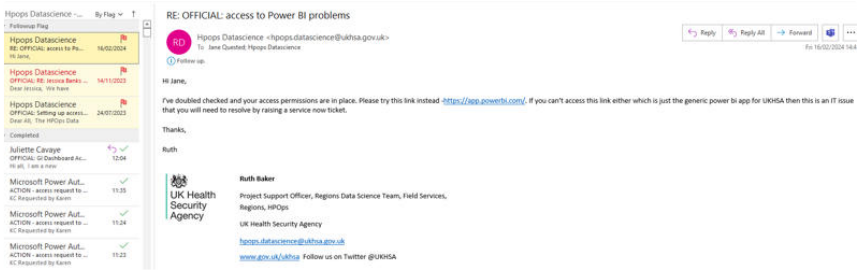
1. Forward the email to the individual's name who has requested the access (dont reply to the MS auto email address).
2. Use the template email captured inside 2.5 Dashboard Access Requests called OFFICIAL: RE: Jessica Banks
3. You dont have to copy hpops and no further action is required.



3.3 Dashboard/Product Access Issues - Trouble shooting Power Bi Specific access (no Jira ticket)

If someone specifically emails regarding HP Source/Winter Dashboard (a power bi dashboard) and when you carry out the troubleshooting steps in [RDS Dashboard Access Process - Regions Data Science - Confluence (phe.org.uk)](#) they do already have access to a relevant MS Azure group - This means they likely have an issue with their IT permissions.

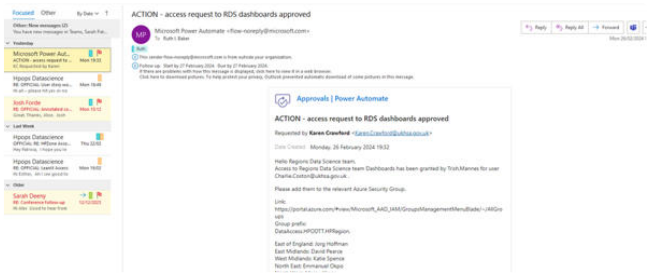
Use the template in 2.5 addressed "Hi Jane"



3.4 Power Automate Requests

When you're on inbox duty, go into this folder every day and deal with each request from your personal email. When you've actioned the request and the email changes to 'approved', you can move the email to folder 2.5 in the team inbox.

These are for regions directorate ONLY staff (as it means they are being set up in an MS Azure group which grants them access to pii in some of our products - PLEASE BE CAUTIOUS!!) - follow the guide contained here [RDS Dashboard Access Process - Regions Data Science - Confluence (phe.org.uk)](#) from "End User types - Regions - FS and HPT staff"



3.5 Non - Regions Directorate staff access request

Specific email requests from either an individual or from one of our own team asking that a **non regions directorate staff** be granted access to a specific product. See here [RDS Dashboard Access Process - Regions Data Science - Confluence (test-and-trace.nhs.uk)](#) and go to 'Development environment access

3.6 Development environment

Requests for someone to be added to the development environment must be approved by the project lead or the project commissioner/key stakeholder. There should never be more than 20 individuals in the dev groups. See here [RDS Dashboard Access Process - Regions Data Science - Confluence (test-and-trace.nhs.uk)](#) and go to 'Development environment access

3.7 Regions Access issues troubleshooting (no Jira ticket)

Please review possible troubleshooting issues here in the 'Trouble shooting section'- **[RDS Dashboard Access Process - Regions Data Science - Confluence (phe.org.uk)](#). This includes removing people from access.**

4. HPDW

⚠ -Any datalake access requests/issues that are not HPDW need to be redirected e.g. those that don't start with S. They are not managed by our team.

-CIMs data issues or feature requests should be re-assigned to Surge to handle instead. Including existing mapped CIMs combo data into new project spaces is managed by the on call data scientist.

⚠ **For any unusual or serious service interruption issues with HPDW, call @Isaac Florence via Teams. If he is out of the office, contact the G7 (System Owner) on rota.**

⚠ **When sending emails to HPDW users, please use the BCC field instead of the To field.**

Email content	Jira ticketing/email	Actions (confluence page link)
Generic access request to an existing project space - If it is a request for information that is answered in HPDW FAQ, i.e how to request access to a specific project	NA	email directly back with some guidance from the page - some generic template examples are shelved in 3.2 under priority flag
Request (possibly from data lake) to sort out access issues to an S project	Add task to this epic FSDS-708: HPDW Service IN PROGRESS Add the component HPDW: Access/Endorser request	possibly back end G7 may need to sign this off
Adding access to a LAMa project	NA	If this requests comes in via email, send to LAMa. SOP found here HPDW: Adding users to project areas
Remove access to a LAMa project	NA	If this requests comes in via email, send to LAMa. SOP found here HPDW: Removing users from project areas
changing project endorsing officer or project owner	Add task to this epic FSDS-708: HPDW Service IN PROGRESS Add the component HPDW: Access/Endorser request	
Set up a New Project space - contains currently mapped CIMs/HPZone combo data	Add task to this epic FSDS-708: HPDW Service IN PROGRESS Add the component HPDW: New project space	
Set up a New Project space - contains any other data set	Add task to this epic FSDS-708: HPDW Service IN PROGRESS Add the component HPDW: New project space	Assign to Back end G7 on rota and alert via Teams
Modifying an existing project space - for currently mapped Cims/HPZone combo data	Add task to this epic FSDS-708: HPDW Service IN PROGRESS Add the component HPDW: Add/Modify views	
Modifying an existing project space - contains any other data set	Add task to this epic FSDS-708: HPDW Service IN PROGRESS Add the component HPDW: Add/Modify views	Assign to Back end G7 on rota and alert via Teams
An issue with CIMs data or a new feature to be captured from CIMs	This should be re-assigned to Surge	NA
An incident related request - often from someone in RIT or from Stephanie Shadwell in HISS	Pick relevant action from above but also include the HPDW: Incident component as well	

5. Ad Hoc SSQs

5.1 Introduction to Ad hocs

⚠ **Important**

Generally emails comes from any of the groups in the title. If **multiple ad hoc requests** come in **check with Alex/Isaac re prioritisation** and if the email comes from someone **outside of the regions directorate check with AB/IF** first as to whether our team should be actioning. **If the email comes from either Will Welfare or the private secretary of Susan Hopkins (Sarah Muhsen) or another senior Director General/their**

private secretary etc then not just a G7 but also AB or IF must review the work and carry out a QA for the ad hoc. Senior Leadership can be checked here: https://intranet.ukhsa.gov.uk/sites/our-groups/document/50269/UKHSA-Senior-Leadership-Organogram-pdf

Generally Carry out the following actions:

1. Generate an epic-less task issue. **Add the component called 'Ad Hoc/SSQ'**.
2. Review if this task is in your capacity, knowledge. If not, find someone in the team who has capacity/skill set to undertake the task. (For SHeD/HPZone record counts person must have SQL and SHeD knowledge.)
3. Assign the Issue to the relevant SEO- give a start date of today, a due date, the commissioner and a basic description of the task and the original email request. Move the task 'to do' so that it appears in the kanban board.
4. Clarify with the sender what the request is (if unclear regarding certain caveats) and what the deadline is if not included in the original email. (**Assume any requests from senior staff need to be completed by EoD or within 24 hours max)**

- Code should be pushed to the AdHoc project in the Regions Data Science GitLab using a branch containing the Jira ticket number, and reviewed and merged by the Surge on duty. Code written pre October 2023 may be found in the Regions Data Science - data and software group on Gitlab.

- Any outputs should be saved to the DataLake network drive (filepor10) in the S121_FS_RDS folder then adhoc_outputs folder. The folder naming conventions should follow that of the AdHoc GitLab.

.

- You must also save a CSV version of your figures even if the stakeholder has only asked for a figure with a Jira ticket number in the name. (this is because we are often asked to re-produce similar requests and it helps maintain consistency in the reports we produce.

- If producing outputs other than tables (e.g. plots or written text), please save the underlying data for those outputs in the folder with the rest of the request, and consider sending them over to the requester.
- You can output directly from R to the network drive by specifying the following path: "//filepor10/DataLake$/S121_FS_RDS/adhoc_outputs/INSERT_FOLDER_NAME/INSERT_FILE_NAME"

- If you need to map the above network drive follow this guide: https://ukhsa.atlassian.net/wiki/display/FSDS/How+to+map+shared+network+drives

- There is also a disease reference list saved here for HPZone/SHeD.

- Common requests:
  - Numbers for (disease) in (time period) with (Confidence level) pulled from HPZone
  - SQL query of SHeD data
  - Issues/fixes to existing products

Intro to SHeD and SQL presentation (Internal)

5.2 Generate CMA Business KPI scorecard from CIMs data for ACT (CMA)

At the beginning of each month, KPI data relating to HPZone/CIMS activity is submitted to the ACT team. This is due by the 5th working day of each month.

SOP:

1. Create an (epic-less) Jira ticket for the current month's submission (Example ticket here: [FSDS-2608]). Ensure the component 'Ad Hoc SSq' has been added. We report the previous month's data, so the ticket will relate to the previous month (i.e. in September the ticket will relate to August data).
2. Pull from the HPZone Reporting repo to obtain the most up to date copy of the KPI script.
3. Run the queries in ACT_requests/hpz_kpi_scorecard_monthly.sql
4. Append the results of each query to the description in the Jira ticket.
5. Notify the G7 on inbox duty that the KPI figures have been generated so that they can be reviewed prior to distribution.
6. Navigate to the CMA KPI Input Template.xlsx spreadsheet
7. This is a data input sheet from the *Assurance, Change, and Transformation* team used to gather figures from across the organisation).
8. Navigate to the **Regions** tab.

9. Enter the '**# New Enquiries**', '**# New Managed Cases**', and '**# New Situations**' figures directly into the spreadsheet table (the other figures are input by other Regions teams, table columns for future months will be greyed out):
10.

HPO3											
Directorate	Metric Name	Metric Target	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Regions	# New Enquiries		5,726	6,846	5,839	5,220	3,294	3,576	3,312	3,055	3,265
Regions	# New Situations		942	914	808	1,046	614	894	1,461	1,335	1,840
Regions	# New Managed Cases		15,925	19,057	17,732	24,003	24,116	23,837	24,982	22,029	18,735
Regions	# of new work plan actions complete with strategic network plans										
Regions	# New FS incidents		31	32	40	21	15	16	25	30	
Regions	# HP intel/surveillance outputs		319	326	261	256	281	234	295	270	

11. If you encounter any issues with the spreadsheet, contact AssuranceChangeTransformation@ukhsa.gov.uk

Please see this ticket for historical context regarding this KPI.

5.3 Top tips

- **Incidents/situations** naming is used interchangeably.
- For cases/situations, **don't include 'discarded'**. If it should never have been a case, it will be deleted and then not available in the view.
- Pulling data off HPZone includes those from **CFI "Center for Infection", Ministry of Defence (MoD), National Port Health, RIT, and Border health (International Travel)**, not just from the regional HPZones. For regional reporting you **do** include RIT and National Port Health.
- **S121_FS_RDS** database in tables there is lkp_unit_region where it maps the different units e.g CFI, RIT to non-HPT
- **[S121_FS_RDS].[dbo].[v_S121_HPZ_Cases]** has all the columns including **LSOA11CD** makes it easy to get the region rather than **[S501_HPODS_dashboards_PID_development].[dbo].[v_S501_HPZ_Cases_anon]** by joining with `[LookupsShared].[dbo].[vLKP_LSOA11]` and `[S501_HPODS_dashboards_PID_development].[dbo].[LTLA22_to_LTLA23_HPT]` .
- If you need to convert from Case_UID to Case_PseudoID see the following tutorial How to convert IDs into Pseudo-IDs.webm
- Please note that when aggregating population data from LTLA to UKHSA regions, it is important to be aware that Milton Keynes is classified under HPT East of England and not South East as per the Office for National Statistics (ONS) Population estimates for England and Wales. Population estimates for England and Wales - Office for National Statistics (ons.gov.uk), Therefore, if necessary, please include a note stating that population estimates in some regions may differ from the ONS estimates, as the aggregations are based on UKHSA regions rather than ONS regions.

6. Handover

On Friday (or the last day of their shift), the OCDS is responsible for adding the upcoming week's OCDS and SDS to the Teams channel, 'Inbox Shift.' They will then brief the next shift on any outstanding queries that need to be followed up on or monitored. Finally, they will remove themselves from the channel.